

An Act

ENROLLED HOUSE
BILL NO. 3021

By: Lowe of the House

and

Pugh of the Senate

An Act relating to schools; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6, as last amended by Section 1, Chapter 264, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 11-103.6), which relates to curriculum requirements for graduation; defining terms; expanding requirements to include certain units or sets of competencies; prohibiting certain diploma pathway from being available to certain students; directing the State Department of Education to develop and distribute certain notice; allowing certain seminar to fulfill certain English requirement; allowing certain indigenous language to fulfill certain world language requirement; allowing certain course to fulfill certain personal financial literacy requirement; adding certain mathematics course for alternate diploma beginning in certain school year; removing language allowing certain core curriculum courses to fulfill certain alternate diploma requirement; allowing certain students to use certain courses to fulfill certain diploma requirements; requiring school districts to offer sufficient courses for students to meet certain requirements; directing certain sequence of units or sets of competencies to be recommended by the State Board of Education, the State Board of Career and Technology Education, and the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education; requiring the State Department of Education's Accreditation Office, in certain consultation, to develop and publish certain guidelines and certain standardized form; providing for contents of form; requiring submission of form annually by certain date; requiring the Department to provide certain feedback and recommendations within

certain time period; allowing the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education to submit certain waiver for program and coursework approval or disapproval; requiring certain framework to be available on the State Department of Education's website; directing the Oklahoma Workforce Commission, in certain coordination, to develop certain catalog for diploma recipients; requiring production of certain catalog by certain school year; requiring biannual update to certain catalog; delaying required submission of certain plan; requiring plan to include certain information; conforming language; updating statutory language; updating statutory references; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6f, which relates to graduation requirement exceptions; allowing a school district board of education to waive certain graduation requirement for certain students who complete certain project or write certain paper; repealing 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6, as last amended by Section 166, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 11-103.6), which relates to curriculum requirements for graduation; repealing 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6, as last amended by Section 1, Chapter 384, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 11-103.6), which relates to curriculum requirements for graduation; providing an effective date; and declaring an emergency.

SUBJECT: Schools

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6, as last amended by Section 1, Chapter 264, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 11-103.6), is amended to read as follows:

Section 11-103.6. A. 1. The State Board of Education shall adopt subject matter standards for instruction of students in the public schools of this state that are necessary to ensure there is attainment of desired levels of competencies in a variety of areas to include language, mathematics, science, social studies, communication, and health and physical education.

2. School districts shall develop and implement curriculum, courses and instruction in order to ensure that students meet the skills and competencies as set forth in this section and in the subject matter standards adopted by the State Board of Education.

3. All students shall gain literacy at the elementary and secondary levels. Students shall develop skills in reading, writing, speaking, computing and critical thinking. For purposes of this section, critical thinking means a manner of analytical thinking which is logical and uses linear factual analysis to reach a conclusion. They shall learn about cultures and environments - their own and those of others with whom they share the earth. All students shall receive the instruction needed to lead healthy and physically active lifestyles. Students, therefore, shall study social studies, literature, languages, the arts, health, mathematics and science. Such curricula shall provide for the teaching of a hands-on career exploration program in cooperation with technology center schools.

4. The subject matter standards shall be designed to teach the competencies for which students shall be tested as provided in Section 1210.508 of this title, and shall be designed to prepare all students for active citizenship, employment and/or successful completion of postsecondary education without the need for remedial coursework at the postsecondary level.

5. The subject matter standards shall be designed with rigor as defined in paragraph ~~3~~ 9 of subsection ~~G~~ B of this section.

6. The subject matter standards for English Language Arts shall give Classic Literature and nonfiction literature equal consideration to other literature. In addition, emphasis shall be given to the study of complete works of literature.

7. At a minimum, the subject matter standards for mathematics shall require mastery of the standard algorithms in mathematics, which is the most logical, efficient way of solving a problem that consistently works, and for students to attain fluency in Euclidian geometry.

8. The subject matter standards for history, social studies and United States Government shall include study of important historical documents, including the United States Constitution, Declaration of Independence, Emancipation Proclamation, Federalist Papers and other

documents with significant history and heritage of the United States, and the content of the United States naturalization test, with an emphasis on the specific content of the test and the ideas and concepts it references. Beginning with the 2022-2023 school year, the United States naturalization test shall be administered in accordance with subsection ~~F~~ G of this section.

9. The subject matter standards for United States Government shall include an emphasis on civics, the structure and relationship between the national, state, county and local governments and simulations of the democratic process. For the purposes of this section, "civics" means the study of the rights and duties of Oklahoma and United States citizens and of how those governments work.

10. The subject matter standards for health and physical education shall include but not be limited to the domains of physical, emotional, social and intellectual health. Health literacy shall include the ability to obtain, process and understand basic health information and services needed to make appropriate health decisions. Health shall also include the importance of proper nutrition and exercise, mental health and wellness, substance abuse, coping skills for understanding and managing trauma, establishing and maintaining positive relationships and responsible decision making. Physical literacy shall include the ability to move with competence and confidence in a wide variety of physical activities in multiple environments that benefit the healthy development of the whole person.

B. For purposes of this section:

1. "Applied knowledge of content" means an educational approach which aids students in connecting standards-based learning with concepts across different subjects for a better understanding of the real-world relevance of the subject matter to enhance critical thinking, improve knowledge retention of the standard and encourage creativity;

2. "Approved for college admission requirements" means courses which are approved by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education for admission to an institution within The Oklahoma State System of Higher Education;

3. "Contextual methodology" means academic content and skills taught by utilizing real-world problems and projects in a way that helps students understand the application of that knowledge;

4. "Locally approved" means a course that has received approval by the local school district board of education and has submitted a nonstandard course waiver notifying the State Department of Education;

5. "Math-based application course" means a course that teaches math content with a real-world application;

6. "Nonstandard course waiver" means the official process which allows a local school district to offer a course for graduation credit that does not fully align with a single set of Oklahoma Academic Standards allowing for flexibility among districts throughout the state while notifying the appropriate statewide systems;

7. "Pathway unit" means a course taken by a high school student that is aligned with the student's current Individualized Career and Academic Plan (ICAP);

8. "Qualified agricultural education courses" means courses that have been determined by the State Board of Education to offer the sets of competencies for one or more science content areas and which correspond to academic science courses. Qualified agricultural education courses shall include, but are not limited to, horticulture, plant and soil science, natural resources and environmental science, and animal science. The courses shall be taught by teachers certified in agricultural education and comply with all rules of the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education;

9. "Rigor" means a level of difficulty that is thorough, exhaustive and accurate and is appropriate for the grade level;

10. "Science-based application course" means a course that teaches science content with a real-world application;

11. "Sets of competencies" means instruction in those skills and competencies that are specified in the subject matter standards adopted by the State Board of Education and other skills and competencies adopted by the Board, without regard to specified instructional time; and

12. "Unit" means a Carnegie Unit as defined by the North Central Association's Commission on Schools.

C. Beginning with students entering the eighth grade in the 2025-2026 school year, in order to graduate from a public high school accredited by the State Board of Education with a standard college-ready and career-ready diploma, students shall complete a minimum of the following twenty-three (23) curriculum units or sets of competencies at the secondary level; beginning with the 2024-2025 school year, with the approval of a parent or legal guardian and subject to school guidance, students may optionally complete the requirements in this subsection in lieu of subsection D of this section to receive a college-ready and career-ready standard diploma:

1. Courses required for credit for high school graduation under this subsection shall also be approved for college admissions requirements;

2. Four units or sets of competencies of English to include Grammar, Composition, Literature, an Advanced Placement English Seminar, or any English course approved for college admission requirements;

3. Four units or sets of competencies of mathematics, two of which shall include Algebra I and either Algebra II or Geometry. The other two units may include Algebra II, Geometry, Trigonometry, Math Analysis, Calculus, Statistics, Math of Finance, Computer Science, college courses approved for dual credit, a full-time postsecondary career and technology program that teaches math content with a real-world application, or locally approved math-based application course, or any mathematics course with applied knowledge of content and rigor above Algebra I. For the purposes of this section, a full-time postsecondary career and technology program that teaches math content with a real-world application shall not include courses categorized as Arts, A/V Technology and Communications, Education and Training, Hospitality and Tourism, or Human Services, including, but not limited to: Barbering, Cosmetology, Culinary Arts, Esthetician, Event Management, Horticulture, or Hospitality Management;

4. Three units or sets of competencies of laboratory science requirements including one unit or set of competencies of life science meeting the standards for Biology I; one unit or set of

competencies of physical science meeting the standards for Physical Science, Chemistry, or Physics; and one unit or set of competencies from the domains of physical science, life science, or earth and space science, or full-time postsecondary career and technology program that teaches science content with a real-world application or locally approved science-based application course, or any science course with applied knowledge of content and rigor above Biology I or Physical Science. For the purposes of this section, a full-time postsecondary career and technology program that teaches science content with a real-world application shall not include courses categorized as Arts, A/V Technology and Communications, Education and Training, Hospitality and Tourism, or Human Services, including, but not limited to: Barbering, Cosmetology, Culinary Arts, Esthetician, Event Management, or Hospitality Management;

5. Three units or sets of competencies of history and citizenship skills including one unit of American History, one-half (1/2) unit of Oklahoma History, one-half (1/2) unit of United States Government, and one unit from the subjects of History, Government, Geography, Economics, Civics, or non-Western culture;

6. Six pathway units or sets of competencies approved at the discretion of the school district board of education which align with each student's Individual Career and Academic Plan (ICAP) and may include, but are not limited to, any additional units or sets of competencies as provided in paragraphs 2 through 5 of this subsection, world language, indigenous language spoken in North America, or non-English language, computer technology, Junior Reserve Officers' Training Corps (JROTC), internship or apprenticeship programs, career and technology education courses, concurrently enrolled courses, Advanced Placement courses, International Baccalaureate courses, music, art, drama, speech, dance, media arts, or other approved courses;

7. One-half (1/2) unit or set of competencies of personal financial literacy, as provided in the Passport to Financial Literacy Act, whether taught as an elective course or when taught during instruction as provided in and subject to the standards of subsection A of Section 11-103.6h of this title in coursework offered by the school district or partnering technology center school by a teacher certified in a relevant secondary subject area and taken in the tenth, eleventh, or twelfth grade. The one-half (1/2) unit in personal financial literacy required under this paragraph may be fulfilled through an Advanced Placement course whose content substantially addresses the required concepts;

8. Three units or sets of competencies of elective courses locally approved by the school district board of education; and

9. At least two additional units or sets of competencies from paragraph 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, or 8 which are required to be approved for college admissions by the State Regents for Higher Education when the student is enrolled in the eighth grade, or at any time thereafter when the student completes the course, but prior to graduation.

D. Subject to the provisions of subsection C of this section, in order to graduate from a public high school accredited by the State Board of Education with a standard college-ready and career-ready diploma, students enrolled in grades eight through twelve in the 2024-2025 school year shall complete the following college preparatory/work ready curriculum units or sets of competencies listed in paragraphs 1 through 8 of this subsection at the secondary level. This subsection shall be unavailable as a diploma pathway to students not enrolled in a public high school accredited by the State Board of Education prior to the 2025-2026 school year for the completion of their diploma, and who have not previously started the pathway provided in this subsection. The State Department of Education shall develop and distribute to school districts a notice suitable for the purposes of notifying parents and legal guardians that this degree pathway is being terminated in the 2029-2030 school year, and students who were not already on the pathway prior to the 2025-2026 school year shall not be eligible for this pathway, and shall be subject to the requirements in subsection C of this section.

1. Four units or sets of competencies of English to include Grammar, Composition, Literature, an Advanced Placement English Seminar, or any English course approved for college admission requirements;

2. Three units or sets of competencies of mathematics, limited to Algebra I, Algebra II, Geometry, Trigonometry, Math Analysis, Calculus, Advanced Placement Statistics, or any mathematics course with applied knowledge of content and/or and rigor above Algebra I and approved for college admission requirements;

3. Three units or sets of competencies of laboratory science approved for college admission requirements including one unit or set of competencies of life science meeting the standards for

Biology I; one unit or set of competencies of physical science, meeting the standards for Physical Science, Chemistry or Physics; and one unit or set of competencies from the domains of physical science, life science, or earth and space science such that the applied knowledge of content and rigor is above Biology I or Physical Science;

4. Three units or sets of competencies of history and citizenship skills, including one unit of American History, one-half (1/2) unit of Oklahoma History, one-half (1/2) unit of United States Government and one unit from the subjects of History, Government, Geography, Economics, Civics, or non-Western culture and approved for college admission requirements;

5. Two units or sets of competencies of the same world language, indigenous language spoken in North America, or non-English language or two units of computer technology approved for college admission requirements, whether taught at a high school or a technology center school, including computer programming, hardware, and business computer applications, such as word processing, databases, spreadsheets, and graphics, excluding keyboarding or typing courses;

6. One additional unit or set of competencies selected from paragraphs 1 through 5 of this subsection or career and technology education courses, concurrently enrolled courses, Advanced Placement courses or International Baccalaureate courses approved for college admission requirements;

7. One-half (1/2) unit or set of competencies of personal financial literacy, as provided in the Passport to Financial Literacy Act, whether taught as an elective course or when taught during instruction as provided in and subject to the standards of subsection A of Section 11-103.6h of this title in coursework offered by the school district or partnering technology center school by a teacher certified in a relevant secondary subject area and taken in the tenth, eleventh, or twelfth grade. The one-half (1/2) unit in personal financial literacy required under this paragraph may be fulfilled through an Advanced Placement course whose content substantially addresses the required concepts; and

8. One unit or set of competencies of fine arts, such as music, art, or drama, or one unit or set of competencies of speech.

~~C.~~ E. In lieu of the requirements of subsection ~~B~~ D of this section which requires a college preparatory/work ready curriculum, a student who was enrolled in grades eight through twelve in the 2024-2025 school year may enroll in the core curriculum as provided in ~~subsection D of this section~~ subsection upon written approval of the parent or legal guardian of the student. For students under the age of eighteen (18) school districts shall require a parent or legal guardian of the student to meet with a designee of the school prior to enrollment in the core curriculum. This subsection shall be unavailable as a diploma pathway to students not enrolled in a public high school accredited by the State Board of Education prior to the 2025-2026 school year. The State Department of Education shall develop and distribute to school districts a form suitable for this purpose, which shall include information on the benefits to students of completing the college preparatory/work ready curriculum as provided for in subsection ~~B~~ D of this section.

~~D.~~ ~~For those students subject to the requirements of subsection C of this section, in~~ In order to graduate from a public high school accredited by the State Board of Education with a standard diploma, students who were enrolled in grades eight through twelve in the 2024-2025 school year shall complete the following core curriculum units or sets of competencies at the secondary level:

1. Language Arts - Four units or sets of competencies, to consist of one unit or set of competencies of grammar and composition, and three units or sets of competencies which may include, but are not limited to, the following courses:

- a. American Literature,
- b. English Literature,
- c. World Literature,
- d. Advanced English Courses, or
- e. other English courses with applied knowledge of content and/or and rigor equal to or above grammar and composition;

2. Mathematics - Three units or sets of competencies to consist of one unit or set of competencies of Algebra I or Algebra I taught in a contextual methodology, and two units or sets of competencies which may include, but are not limited to, the following courses:

- a. Algebra II,
- b. Geometry or Geometry taught in a contextual methodology,
- c. Trigonometry,
- d. Math Analysis or Precalculus,
- e. Calculus,
- f. Statistics and/or Probability,
- g. Computer Science or acceptance and successful completion of one (1) year of a full-time, three-hour career and technology program leading to an industry credential/certificate or college credit. The State Board of Career and Technology Education shall promulgate rules to define the provisions of this section related to the accepted industry-valued credentials which are industry-endorsed or industry-aligned. The list of accepted industry-valued credentials shall be reviewed annually and updated at least every three (3) years by the Board,
- h.
 - (1) contextual mathematics courses which enhance technology preparation, or
 - (2) a science, technology, engineering and math (STEM) block course meeting the requirements for course competencies listed in paragraph 2 of subsection ~~B~~ D of this section, whether taught at a:
 - (a) comprehensive high school, or
 - (b) technology center school when taken in the tenth, eleventh or twelfth grade, taught by a certified teacher, and approved by the State Board of Education and the independent district board of education,
- i. mathematics courses taught at a technology center school by a teacher certified in the secondary subject

area when taken in the tenth, eleventh or twelfth grade upon approval of the State Board of Education and the independent district board of education, or

- j. any other mathematics course with applied knowledge of content ~~and/or~~ and rigor equal to or above Algebra I;

3. Science - Three units or sets of competencies to consist of one unit or set of competencies of Biology I or Biology I taught in a contextual methodology, and two units or sets of competencies in the areas of life, physical, or earth science or technology which may include, but are not limited to, the following courses:

- a. Chemistry I,
- b. Physics,
- c. Biology II,
- d. Chemistry II,
- e. Physical Science,
- f. Earth Science,
- g. Botany,
- h. Zoology,
- i. Anatomy and Physiology,
- j. Astronomy,
- k. Applied Biology/Chemistry,
- l. Applied Physics,
- m. Principles of Technology,
- n. qualified agricultural education courses,
- o. (1) contextual science courses which enhance technology preparation, or

(2) a science, technology, engineering and math (STEM) block course meeting the requirements for course competencies listed in paragraph 3 of subsection ~~B~~ D of this section, whether taught at a:

(a) comprehensive high school, or

(b) technology center school when taken in the tenth, eleventh or twelfth grade, taught by a certified teacher, and approved by the State Board of Education and the independent district board of education,

p. science courses taught at a technology center school by a teacher certified in the secondary subject area when taken in the tenth, eleventh or twelfth grade upon approval of the State Board of Education and the independent district board of education, or

q. other science courses with applied knowledge of content ~~and/or~~ and rigor equal to or above Biology I;

4. Social Studies - Three units or sets of competencies, to consist of one unit or set of competencies of United States History, one-half (1/2) to one unit or set of competencies of United States Government, one-half (1/2) unit or set of competencies of Oklahoma History, and one-half (1/2) to one unit or set of competencies which may include, but are not limited to, the following courses:

a. World History,

b. Geography,

c. Economics,

d. Anthropology, or

e. other social studies courses with applied knowledge of content ~~and/or~~ and rigor equal to or above United States History, United States Government, and Oklahoma History;

5. Arts - One unit or set of competencies which may include, but is not limited to, courses in Visual Arts and General Music;

6. One-half (1/2) unit or set of competencies of personal financial literacy, as provided in the Passport to Financial Literacy Act, whether taught as an elective course or when taught during instruction as provided in and subject to the standards of subsection A of Section 11-103.6h of this title in coursework offered by the school district or partnering technology center school by a teacher certified in a relevant secondary subject area and taken in the tenth, eleventh, or twelfth grade. The one-half (1/2) unit in personal financial literacy required under this paragraph may be fulfilled through an Advanced Placement (AP) course whose content substantially addresses the required concepts; and

7. Computer Education or World Language - One unit or set of competencies of computer technology, whether taught at a high school or a technology center school, including computer programming, hardware and business computer applications, such as word processing, databases, spreadsheets and graphics, excluding keyboarding or typing courses, or one unit or set of competencies of world language, indigenous language spoken in North America, or non-English language.

~~E.~~ F. 1. A school district may issue an alternate diploma to a student who meets the definition of a student with the most significant cognitive disabilities and who participates in the Oklahoma Alternate Assessment Program (OAAP) beginning in the 2023-2024 school year. An alternate diploma shall be standards-based, aligned with requirements for a standard diploma in subsection C, D, or E of this section, and obtained by the school year in which a student turns twenty-two (22) years of age.

~~F.~~ 2. An alternate diploma issued in accordance with this subsection shall not terminate a Free and Appropriate Public Education (FAPE) for students with an Individualized Education Program (IEP) unless they reach the maximum age of FAPE. The IEP team shall determine subsequent courses and services for students participating in OAAP who receive an alternate diploma under this subsection.

~~G.~~ 3. Students participating in the OAAP shall not be precluded from attempting to meet the requirements of a standard diploma program under this section, and participation in the OAAP shall be assessed by alternative achievement standards that promote access to and progress in the general education curriculum, and shall not

determine a student's educational setting under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA).

~~H.~~ 4. Students who meet requirements for an alternate diploma under this section may count as having received a standard diploma for purposes of calculating and reporting the adjusted cohort graduation rate (ACGR).

~~I.~~ 5. A student may be awarded an alternate diploma upon completion of the following curriculum units or sets of competencies at the secondary level consistent with the academic plan of the student:

~~1.~~

a. Language Arts - Four units or sets of competencies based on alternate academic achievement standards to consist of reading literature, reading informational text, writing, speaking and listening, and language in the following courses:

~~a.~~

(1) English 1 Alternate,

~~b.~~

(2) English 2 Alternate,

~~c.~~

(3) English 3 Alternate, and

~~d.~~

(4) English 4 Alternate~~+~~,

~~2.~~

b. (1) Mathematics - For students enrolled in grades eight through twelve in the 2024-2025 school year and attending a public high school accredited by the State Board of Education prior to the 2025-2026 school year: Three units or sets of competencies based on alternate academic achievement standards to consist of number, quantities, algebra, functions/statistics, probability, and geometry in the following courses:

~~a.~~

- (a) Math Alternate 1,
 - ~~b.~~ (b) Math Alternate 2, and
 - ~~c.~~ (c) Math Alternate 3~~+~~,
- (2) Mathematics - Beginning with students entering the eighth grade in the 2025-2026 school year: Four units or sets of competencies based on alternate academic achievement standards to consist of number, quantities, algebra, functions/statistics, probability, and geometry in the following courses:
 - (a) Math Alternate 1,
 - (b) Math Alternate 2,
 - (c) Math Alternate 3, and
 - (d) Math Alternate 4,

~~3.~~

- c. Science - Three units or sets of competencies based on alternate academic achievement standards to consist of life science, physical science, and earth science in the following courses:

- ~~a.~~ (1) Life Science Alternate,
- ~~b.~~ (2) Physical Science Alternate, and
- ~~c.~~ (3) Earth Science Alternate~~+~~,

~~4.~~

- d. Social Studies - Three units or sets of competencies based on alternate academic achievement standards to consist of United States History, United States Government, Oklahoma History, Geography, and Social Studies in the following courses:

~~a.~~

(1) Social Studies Alternate 1,

~~b.~~

(2) Social Studies Alternate 2, and

~~c.~~

(3) Social Studies Alternate 3~~+~~,

~~5.~~

e. Arts - One unit or set of competencies which may include, but is not limited to, courses in Visual Arts and General Music~~+~~,

~~6.~~

f. Computer Education or World Language - One unit or set of competencies of computer technology, whether taught at a high school or a technology center school, including computer programming, hardware, and business computer applications, such as word processing, databases, spreadsheets, and graphics, excluding keyboarding or typing courses, or one unit or set of competencies of world language, indigenous language spoken in North America or non-English language~~+~~,

~~7.~~

g. Career Readiness - at least two units of Career Readiness, including Career Readiness I, Career Readiness II, Career Readiness III, or Career Readiness IV. Each Career Readiness course may be substituted for Careers/Exploration, Internship I, or Internship II~~+~~and,

~~8.~~

h. Life Skills - at least two units of Life Skills, such as Life Skills I, Life Skills II, Life Skills III, or Life Skills IV. Each Life Skills course may be substituted for the Life Skills or Family and Consumer Science courses~~+~~and

~~J. Courses in the core curriculum may be used as a substitute for corresponding courses required by the alternate diploma. Other courses may be substituted as determined by the State Board of Education.~~

~~K. 1. In addition to the curriculum requirements of either subsection B or D of this section, in order to graduate from a public high school accredited by the State Board of Education students shall complete any additional course requirements or recommended elective courses as may be established by the State Board of Education and the district school board. School districts shall strongly encourage students to complete two units or sets of competencies of world languages and two units or sets of competencies of physical and health education.~~

~~2. No student shall receive credit for high school graduation more than once for completion of the same unit or set of competencies to satisfy the curriculum requirements of this section.~~

~~3. A school district shall not be required to offer every course listed in subsections B and D of this section but shall offer sufficient courses to allow a student to meet the graduation requirements during the secondary grade years of the student.~~

~~L.~~

- i. any course available at the school consistent with the student's academic plan may be used as corresponding courses required for a student participating in OAAP to achieve a diploma. Other courses may be locally approved.

G. 1. In addition to the curriculum requirements of either subsection ~~B or C~~, D, or E of this section, beginning with ninth graders in the 2021-22 school year, in order to graduate from a public high school accredited by the State Board of Education, students shall pass the United States naturalization test pursuant to the provisions of this subsection.

2. School districts shall offer the United States naturalization test to students at least once per school year, beginning as early as eighth grade at the discretion of the school district; provided, any student may retake the exam upon request, and as often as desired, until earning a passing score. For purposes of this subsection, a passing score shall be 60 out of 100 questions.

3. School districts shall exempt students with disabilities whose individualized education program (IEP), consistent with state and federal law, indicates that the student is to be assessed with alternate achievement standards through the OAAP.

~~M. For purposes of this section:~~

~~1. "Contextual methodology" means academic content and skills taught by utilizing real-world problems and projects in a way that helps students understand the application of that knowledge;~~

~~2. "Qualified agricultural education courses" means courses that have been determined by the State Board of Education to offer the sets of competencies for one or more science content areas and which correspond to academic science courses. Qualified agricultural education courses shall include, but are not limited to, Horticulture, Plant and Soil Science, Natural Resources and Environmental Science, and Animal Science. The courses shall be taught by teachers certified in agricultural education and comply with all rules of the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education;~~

~~3. "Rigor" means a level of difficulty that is thorough, exhaustive and accurate and is appropriate for the grade level;~~

~~4. "Sets of competencies" means instruction in those skills and competencies that are specified in the subject matter standards adopted by the State Board of Education and other skills and competencies adopted by the Board, without regard to specified instructional time; and~~

~~5. "Unit" means a Carnegie Unit as defined by the North Central Association's Commission on Schools.~~

In addition to the curriculum requirements of subsection C, D, or E of this section, in order to graduate from a public high school accredited by the State Board of Education, students shall complete the requirements for a personal financial literacy passport as set forth in the Passport to Financial Literacy Act and any additional course requirements or recommended elective courses as may be established by the State Board of Education and the district school board.

5. The one-half (1/2) unit or set of competencies in personal financial literacy required in subsection C, D, or E of this section shall be completed in the tenth, eleventh, or twelfth grade to fulfill the requirements for graduation.

6. A school district shall not be required to offer every course listed in subsections C, D, and E of this section but districts shall offer sufficient courses to allow students to meet the graduation requirements and ensure the student meets the coursework requirements established for Oklahoma's Promise by the Oklahoma State Regents of Higher Education.

7. No student shall receive credit for high school graduation more than once for completion of the same unit or set of competencies to satisfy the curriculum requirements of this section.

8. All units or sets of competencies required for graduation may be taken in any sequence recommended by the school district, the State Board of Education, State Board of Career and Technology Education, and State Regents for Higher Education.

9. As a condition of receiving accreditation from the State Board of Education, all students in grades nine through twelve shall enroll in a minimum of six periods, or the equivalent in block scheduling or other scheduling structure, consistent with and meeting minimum school day and hour requirements as prescribed by state law, that allows for instruction in sets of competencies, of rigorous academic, concurrent enrollment, apprenticeships, and rigorous vocational courses each day, which may include arts, vocal and instrumental music, speech classes, and physical education classes.

10. The units or sets of competencies in mathematics required in subsection C, D, or E of this section shall be completed in the eighth through twelfth grades. If a student completes any required courses or sets of competencies in mathematics prior to eighth grade, the student may take any other mathematics courses or sets of competencies to fulfill the requirement to complete the units or sets of competencies in grades eight through twelve after the student has satisfied the requirements of subsection C, D, or E of this section.

11. Credit for the units or sets of competencies required in subsection C, D, or E of this section shall be given when such units or sets of competencies are taken prior to ninth grade if the teachers are certified or authorized to teach the subjects for high school credit and the required rigor is maintained.

12. A school district shall determine the specific description of the locally approved math- and science-based application courses

allowed pursuant to paragraphs 2 and 3 of subsection D of this section. Formal notification with the specific course description shall be provided to the State Department of Education prior to July 1 of each school year. The notification shall include what courses will be coded as locally approved math- and science-based application courses for the ensuing school year.

H. 1. The State Department of Education's Accreditation Office, in consultation with the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education and the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education, shall develop and publish guidelines for local curriculum development, and a standardized form for submission for notification and review. The form shall be called a Nonstandard Course Waiver for the purposes of reviewing and standardizing the rigor of courses locally approved by public school district boards of education. The Nonstandard Course Waiver shall require, at minimum, the following information:

- a. name of the course to be considered,
- b. specific description,
- c. learning objectives,
- d. a course syllabus,
- e. a crosswalk of the course syllabus and objectives to the appropriate course or courses' Oklahoma Academic Standards,
- f. proposed credit to be granted for the course, and
- g. date and vote of approval by the local district school board.

2. Courses shall be presented to local district boards of education utilizing the Nonstandard Course Waiver, and any additional information required by the appropriate local boards.

3. The Nonstandard Course Waiver shall be submitted to the State Department of Education's Accreditation Office no later than March 1 annually for new locally approved courses. Courses locally approved by local school district boards of education shall be reviewed for completion by the State Department of Education's

Accreditation Office. Locally approved courses with changes to the student learning outcomes in the syllabus shall be resubmitted.

4. The State Department of Education Accreditation Office shall return any feedback and recommendations to the local district no later than thirty (30) days following receipt of the waiver.

5. The Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education may submit the Nonstandard Course Waiver to the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education for program and coursework approval or disapproval for college admissions requirements.

6. Framework for locally approved courses approved by local school district boards of education, to include the Oklahoma Academic Standards crosswalk, locally developed syllabus, and district contact name shall all be made publicly available on the State Department of Education website.

~~N. I.~~ 1. The State Board of Education shall adopt a plan to ensure that rigor is maintained in the content, teaching methodology, level of expectations for student achievement, and application of learning in all the courses taught to meet the graduation requirements as specified in this section.

2. The State Board of Education shall allow as much flexibility at the district level as is possible without diminishing the rigor or undermining the intent of providing these courses. To accomplish this purpose, the State Department of Education shall work with school districts in reviewing and approving courses taught by districts that are not specifically listed in subsections ~~B~~ and C, D, and E of this section. Options may include, but shall not be limited to, courses taken by concurrent enrollment, advanced placement, or correspondence, or courses bearing different titles.

3. The State Board of Education shall approve an advanced placement computer science course to meet the requirements of course competencies listed in paragraph 2 of subsection ~~B~~ D of this section if the course is taken in a student's senior year and the student is concurrently enrolled in or has successfully completed Algebra II.

4. Any student who completes the curriculum requirements of the International Baccalaureate Diploma Program shall be awarded a standard diploma.

5. Any student who successfully completes an advanced mathematics or science course offered pursuant to Section 1210.404 of this title shall be granted academic credit toward meeting the graduation requirements pursuant to paragraph 3 or 4, as appropriate, of subsection C or paragraph 2 or 3 of subsection D or E of this section.

6. The State Board of Education shall provide an option for high school graduation based upon attainment of the desired levels of competencies as required in tests pursuant to the provisions of Section 1210.508 of this title. Such option shall be in lieu of the amount of course credits earned.

7. The State Board of Education shall prescribe, adopt and approve a promotion system based on the attainment by students of specified levels of competencies in each area of the core curriculum.

8. Technology center school districts may offer programs designed in cooperation with institutions of higher education which have an emphasis on a focused field of career study upon approval of the State Board of Education and the independent district board of education. Students in the tenth grade may be allowed to attend these programs for up to one-half (1/2) of a school day and credit for the units or sets of competencies required in paragraphs 3, 4, 6, and 7 of subsection C or paragraphs 2, 3, 6, and 7 of subsection ~~B or D or E~~ of this section shall be given if the courses are taught by a teacher certified in the secondary subject area; provided, credit for units or sets of competencies pursuant to subsection ~~B C, D, or E~~ of this section ~~shall be approved~~ are subject to approval for college admission requirements.

~~5.~~

9. a. If a student enrolls in a concurrent course, the school district shall not be responsible for any costs incurred for that course, unless the school district does not offer enough course selection during the student's secondary grade years to allow the student to receive the courses needed to meet the graduation requirements of this section. If the school district does not offer the necessary course selection during the student's secondary grade years, it shall be responsible for the cost of resident tuition at an institution in The Oklahoma State System of Higher Education, fees, and books for the concurrent

enrollment course, and providing for transportation to and from the institution to the school site.

- b. It is the intent of the Legislature that for students enrolled in a concurrent enrollment course which is paid for by the school district pursuant to this paragraph, the institution charge only the supplementary and special service fees that are directly related to the concurrent enrollment course and enrollment procedures for that student. It is further the intent of the Legislature that fees for student activities and student service facilities, including the student health care and cultural and recreational service fees, not be charged to such students.

~~6. Credit for the units or sets of competencies required in subsection B or D of this section shall be given when such units or sets of competencies are taken prior to ninth grade if the teachers are certified or authorized to teach the subjects for high school credit and the required rigor is maintained.~~

~~7. The three units or sets of competencies in mathematics required in subsection B or D of this section shall be completed in the ninth through twelfth grades. If a student completes any required courses or sets of competencies in mathematics prior to ninth grade, the student may take any other mathematics courses or sets of competencies to fulfill the requirement to complete three units or sets of competencies in grades nine through twelve after the student has satisfied the requirements of subsection B or D of this section.~~

~~8. The one half (1/2) unit or set of competencies in personal financial literacy required in subsection B or D of this section shall be completed in the tenth, eleventh, or twelfth grade to fulfill the requirements for graduation.~~

~~9. All units or sets of competencies required for graduation may be taken in any sequence recommended by the school district.~~

~~0. As a condition of receiving accreditation from the State Board of Education, all students in grades nine through twelve shall enroll in a minimum of six periods, or the equivalent in block scheduling or other scheduling structure that allows for instruction in sets of competencies, of rigorous academic and/or rigorous~~

~~vocational courses each day, which may include arts, vocal and instrumental music, speech classes, and physical education classes.~~

~~P.~~ 1. 10. Academic and vocational-technical courses designed to offer sets of competencies integrated or embedded within the courses that provide for the teaching and learning of the appropriate skills and knowledge in the subject matter standards, as adopted by the State Board of Education, may, upon approval of the Board, in consultation with the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education if the courses are offered at a technology center school district, be counted for academic credit and toward meeting the graduation requirements of this section.

~~2.~~ 11. Internet-based courses offered by a technology center school that are taught by a certified teacher and provide for the teaching and learning of the appropriate skills and knowledge in the subject matter standards may, upon approval of the State Board of Education and the independent district board of education, be counted for academic credit and toward meeting the graduation requirements of this section.

~~3.~~ 12. Internet-based courses or vocational-technical courses utilizing integrated or embedded skills for which no subject matter standards have been adopted by the State Board of Education may be approved by the Board, in consultation with the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education if the courses are offered at a technology center school district, if such courses incorporate standards of nationally recognized professional organizations and are taught by certified teachers.

~~4.~~ 13. Courses offered by a supplemental education organization that is accredited by a national accrediting body and that are taught by a certified teacher and provide for the teaching and learning of the appropriate skills and knowledge in the subject matter standards may, upon approval of the State Board of Education and the school district board of education, be counted for academic credit and toward meeting the graduation requirements of this section.

~~Q.~~ ~~The State Board of Education shall provide an option for high school graduation based upon attainment of the desired levels of competencies as required in tests pursuant to the provisions of Section 1210.508 of this title. Such option shall be in lieu of the amount of course credits earned.~~

~~R. The State Board of Education shall prescribe, adopt and approve a promotion system based on the attainment by students of specified levels of competencies in each area of the core curriculum.~~

~~S. Children who have an IEP pursuant to the IDEA, and who satisfy the graduation requirements through the individualized education program for that student shall be awarded a standard diploma.~~

~~T. 14. Students who enter the ninth grade in or prior to the 2007-08 school year who are enrolled in an alternative education program and meet the requirements of their plans leading to high school graduation developed pursuant to Section 1210.568 of this title shall be awarded a standard diploma.~~

~~U. Any student who completes the curriculum requirements of the International Baccalaureate Diploma Program shall be awarded a standard diploma.~~

~~V. Any student who successfully completes an advanced mathematics or science course offered pursuant to Section 1210.404 of this title shall be granted academic credit toward meeting the graduation requirements pursuant to paragraph 2 or 3, as appropriate, of subsection B or D of this section.~~

~~W. For purposes of this section, the courses approved for college admission requirements shall be courses which are approved by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education for admission to an institution within The Oklahoma State System of Higher Education.~~

~~X. 15. Students who have been denied a standard diploma by the school district in which the student is or was enrolled for failing to meet the requirements of this section may re-enroll in the school district that denied the student a standard diploma following the denial of a standard diploma. The student shall be provided remediation or intervention and the opportunity to complete the curriculum units or sets of competencies required by this section to obtain a standard diploma. Students who re-enroll in the school district to meet the graduation requirements of this section shall be exempt from the hourly instructional requirements of Section 1-111 of this title and the six-period enrollment requirements of this section.~~

~~J.~~ J. Consistent with its existing mission and outreach, the Workforce Commission, in coordination with the State Department of Education, shall develop a catalog of Oklahoma business labor force endorsements for diploma recipients identifying entry-level positions throughout the state that are available, potentially hiring, in need, and fillable by students graduating with a high school diploma pursuant to subsections C and F of this section. The catalog shall identify the company, positions, area of the state, demand for the job positions, and high school courses that would create an ideal candidate graduating from an accredited Oklahoma high school. The first production of the catalog shall be made available to the State Department of Education for distribution to public school districts by the beginning of the 2027-2028 school year and shall be updated biannually.

K. The State Department of Education shall collect and report data by school site and district on the number of students who enroll in the core curriculum as provided in subsection ~~D~~ E of this section. The State Board of Education, State Board of Career and Technology Education, and State Regents for Higher Education shall adopt a joint plan and electronically submit it to the Speaker of the Oklahoma House of Representatives and the President Pro Tempore of the Oklahoma State Senate by January 1, 2027, to ensure that rigor is maintained in the content, teaching methodology, level of expectations for student achievement, and application of learning in all the courses taught to meet the graduation requirements specified in subsections C, D, E, and F of this section. Such plan shall include, but not be limited to, the number of nonstandard course waivers submitted, rejected, and approved pursuant to subsection H of this section, and graduation rates for each school district.

SECTION 2. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6f, is amended to read as follows:

Section 11-103.6f. A. Prior to September 1, 2003, the State Board of Education shall adopt rules to ensure that students who transfer into an Oklahoma school district from out of state after the junior year of high school of the student shall not be denied, due to differing graduation requirements, the opportunity to be awarded a standard diploma.

B. The rules shall allow district boards of education to make exceptions on an individual student basis to the high school graduation requirements of Section 11-103.6 of this title for such students who would be unable to meet the specific graduation

requirements without extending the date of graduation. Each district board of education that grants exceptions pursuant to this subsection shall report to the State Department of Education on or before July 1 of each year the number of students granted exceptions and reasons for the exceptions.

C. By December 1, 2015, the State Board of Education shall adopt rules requiring school district boards of education to waive the Oklahoma history high school graduation requirements of Section 11-103.6 of this title for children of military families as defined in the Interstate Compact on Educational Opportunity for Military Children, set forth in Section 510.1 of this title, who transition with the military from another state and who have satisfactorily completed a similar state history class or other one-half (1/2) unit or set of competencies in history or citizenship skills in another state. The school district board of education may also waive the Oklahoma History high school graduation requirements for a student who meets the criteria provided in this subsection if the student completes a project or writes a paper, without the assistance of artificial intelligence, subject to approval of the school district, that demonstrates competencies and knowledge of Oklahoma history or United States Government.

SECTION 3. REPEALER 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6, as last amended by Section 166, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 11-103.6), is hereby repealed.

SECTION 4. REPEALER 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6, as last amended by Section 1, Chapter 384, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 11-103.6), is hereby repealed.

SECTION 5. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

SECTION 6. It being immediately necessary for the preservation of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

Passed the House of Representatives the 7th day of May, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

Passed the Senate the 14th day of May, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

Received by the Office of the Governor this _____
day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.
By: _____

Approved by the Governor of the State of Oklahoma this _____
day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

Governor of the State of Oklahoma

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____
day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.
By: _____